

David DeFranza

Curriculum vitae

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UCD Graduate Business School
Carysfort Avenue, Blackrock
Co. Dublin.

Website: daviddefranza.com
Email: david.defranza@ucd.ie

EDUCATION

- 2022 Ph.D., Business Administration (Marketing), David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah
- 2015 M.B.A., Poole College of Management, North Carolina State University
- 2015 M.A., Technology and Communication, Hussman School of Journalism and Media, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
- 2005 B.A., History, University of New Hampshire

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

- 2022-present Assistant Professor of Marketing, Michael Smurfit Graduate Business School, University College Dublin, National University of Ireland

PUBLICATIONS

1. Bae, Soo Young, & **David DeFranza**. (2026). Unequal penalties: User status dynamics in the spread of social media misinformation. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*. In press.
2. Vijayakumar, Suhas, W. Yuna Yang, & **David DeFranza**. (2026). Lay belief about AI and its decision-making. *Frontiers in Computer Science*, 8(1768435), 1-11. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fcomp.2026.1768435>
3. **DeFranza, David**, Mike Lindow, Kevin Harrison, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. (2021). Religion and reactance to COVID-19 mitigation guidelines. *American Psychologist*, 76(5), 744-754. <https://doi.org/10.1037/amp0000717>
4. **DeFranza, David**, Himanshu Mishra, & Arul Mishra. (2020). How language shapes prejudice against women: An examination across 45 world languages. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 119(1), 7-22. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pspa0000188>

Peer-Reviewed Conference Proceedings

1. Bae, Soo Young, & **David DeFranza**. (2025). Who controls the narrative? The dual role of contributors and amplifiers in online activism. In *2025 Proceedings of the Paris Conference on AI & Digital Ethics* (pp. 46-57). The Paris Journal on AI & Digital Ethics. <https://doi.org/10.65701/r8z1p3t6c9>

2. Lindow, Mike, **David DeFranza**, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. (2021). Partisanship and fear are associated with resistance to COVID-19 directives. In *Proceedings of the Eleventh Workshop on Computational Approaches to Subjectivity, Sentiment and Social Media Analysis (WASSA)* (pp. 25–33). European Association of Computational Linguistics.

Other Publications

1. Stanko, Michael, William Rand, & **David DeFranza**. (2017). Search engine optimization: Note for marketing managers (updated). *Ivey Publishing*.

SOFTWARE

1. **DeFranza, David**. (2026). *gradLasso: Gradient descent LASSO with stability selection and bootstrapped confidence intervals* (Version 0.1.1) [R package]. CRAN. <https://doi.org/10.32614/CRAN.package.gradLasso>

RESEARCH GRANTS

1. Ling, Aiqing, **David DeFranza**, Julie Schiro, Nguyen Nguyen, Marius Claudy, Michael Geers, Mark Pagell, Mary Parkinson, Saskia van Ruth, Suhas Vijayakumar, & W. Yuna Yang. (2025). “Neurophysiological equipment and GPU stations for UCD Smurfit School Behavioural Lab.” Higher Education Research Equipment Grant (HEREG) Scheme, University College Dublin. 1 year, €198,000, Role: Co-Investigator.
2. **DeFranza, David** & Anshu Suri. (2024). “Shefying products: How ascribing gender to inanimate objects leads to increased engagement and perpetuates gender stereotypes.” College of Business Research Funding Scheme, University College Dublin. 1 year, €7,957, Role: Co-PI.
3. Ling, Aiqing, **David DeFranza**, Julie Schiro, Suhas Vijayakumar, & W. Yuna Yang. (2024). “Co-piloting with AI: Pedagogical applications of generative systems in the higher education classroom.” College of Business Teaching Development Funding Scheme, University College Dublin. 1 year, €2,500, Role: Co-PI.
4. **DeFranza, David** & Soo Young Bae. (2024). “The impact of opinion leaders in the propagation and correction of misinformation.” UCD-UMass Amherst Seed Funding for Strategic Research Initiatives, University College Dublin & University of Massachusetts Amherst. 1 year, €10,000, Role: Co-PI.
5. **DeFranza, David**. (2022). “The dynamics of parasocial relationships following influencer endorsements.” College of Business Research Funding Scheme, University College Dublin. 1 year, €2,400, Role: PI.

AWARDS & HONORS

2024 2023-2024 College of Business Teaching Excellence Award, University College Dublin
 2023 2022-2023 Dean’s List of Outstanding Teachers, University College Dublin
 2021 Marketing Doctoral Student Teaching Excellence Award, University of Utah
 2021 Poster Competition, 2nd place award, INFORMS Business Analytics Conference
 2021 Fellow, AMA-Sheth Foundation Doctoral Consortium

2020 Monty & Christine Botosan Bridge to Practice Doctoral Award, University of Utah
2019 Fellow, ISMS Doctoral Consortium

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

* denotes presenter; † denotes mentee presenter

Papers Presented

1. **DeFranza, David***, Pronobesh Banerjee, & Promothesh Chatterjee. Unveiling the cross-cultural influence of sentiment variability on online helpfulness votes. *European Marketing Academy Conference*. Bath, England. June 2-5, 2026.
2. Nguyen, Nguyen*, **David DeFranza**, Xue Zhang, Shengnan Ren & Hongbo Yu. The dual paths of envy: Comparing human and virtual influencers. *European Marketing Academy Conference*. Bath, England. June 2-5, 2026.
3. Zhang, Xue†, **David DeFranza**, & Marius Claudy. The psychological and behavioral impacts of virtual influencers: A systematic review. *European Marketing Academy Conference*. Bath, England. June 2-5, 2026.
4. Bae, Soo Young*, & **David DeFranza**. Digital hierarchies and misinformation: How user status shapes the spread of misinformation. *World Association for Public Opinion Research (WAPOR) Asia Pacific Chapter Conference*. Tokyo, Japan. November 21-23, 2025.
5. Bae, Soo Young*, & **David DeFranza***. Misinformation on social media: How high-status users shape online public discourse. *International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR) Conference*. Singapore. July 13-17, 2025.
6. Bae, Soo Young, & **David DeFranza***. Misinformation, influence, and algorithmic bias: The role of high-status users in misinformation spread. *Paris Conference on AI & Digital Ethics 2025*. Paris, France. June 16-17, 2025.
7. Bae, Soo Young*, & **David DeFranza**. Who controls the narrative? The dual role of contributors and amplifiers in online activism. *Paris Conference on AI & Digital Ethics 2025*. Paris, France. June 16-17, 2025.
8. **DeFranza, David***, & Shelly Rathee. Bad ideas attract attention while good ideas are ignored. *European Marketing Academy Conference*. Pozuelo, Spain. May 27-30, 2025.
9. **DeFranza, David***, & Promothesh Chatterjee. When a week is not a week: How temporal boundaries impact event perception. *Journal of the Association for Consumer Research Time in Consumption Boutique Conference*. Virtual. August 19-20, 2024.
10. Vijayakumar, Suhas, W. Yuna Yang, & **David DeFranza***. Lay beliefs about AI and its consequent outcomes. *Multidisciplinary Workshop on Cyber-Physical Systems (CPS) at The University of Glasgow*. Glasgow, Scotland. April 16, 2024.
11. **DeFranza, David***, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. Gender class assignment is associated with stereotypical attitudes toward brand names. *Society for Consumer Psychology*. San Juan, Puerto Rico. March 2-4, 2023.

12. **DeFranza, David***, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. How grammatical gender influences attitudes toward brand names. *Society for Personality and Social Psychology*. Atlanta, Georgia. February 23-25, 2023.
13. **DeFranza, David***, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. How language perpetuates gender stereotypes and prejudices. *15th Irish Economics and Psychology Conference*. Dublin, Ireland. December 16, 2022.
14. **DeFranza, David***, & Promothesh Chatterjee. Regulatory focus shifts in response to arbitrary temporal boundaries: A quasi-experiment on Twitter. *ISMS Marketing Science Conference*. Virtual. June 16-18, 2022.
15. **DeFranza, David***, & Promothesh Chatterjee. How arbitrary temporal borders affect consumer perceptions of an upcoming event. *Marketing Analytics Symposium*. Sydney, Australia. May 26-27, 2022.
16. **DeFranza, David***, Pronobesh Banerjee, & Promothesh Chatterjee. The influence of dialectical reasoning on Amazon product reviews. *8th Pan IIM World Management Conference*. Virtual. December 16-18, 2021.
17. **DeFranza, David***, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. The influence of language on attitudes toward brands. *AMA Summer Academic Conference*. Virtual. August 4-6, 2021.
18. **DeFranza, David***, Pronobesh Banerjee, & Promothesh Chatterjee. The influence of culture and dialectical reasoning on Amazon product reviews. *ISMS Marketing Science Conference*. Virtual. June 3-5, 2021.
19. Lindow, Mike*, **David DeFranza**, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. Partisanship and fear are associated with resistance to COVID-19 directives. *Eleventh Workshop on Computational Approaches to Subjectivity, Sentiment and Social Media Analysis (WASSA)*. Virtual. April 19, 2021.
20. **DeFranza, David***, Mike Lindow, Kevin Harrison, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. Religion and reactance to COVID-19 mitigation guidelines. *3i COVID-19 Flash Talks*. Salt Lake City, Utah. October 2, 2020.
21. **DeFranza, David***, Himanshu Mishra, & Arul Mishra. Extracting and analyzing psychological constructs from text data: The example of gender prejudice across languages. *Marketing Analytics Symposium*. Sydney, Australia. February 3-4, 2020.
22. **DeFranza, David***, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. How language shapes bias against women: A study of implicit gender bias in 45 world languages. *ISMS Marketing Science Conference*. Rome, Italy. June 20-22, 2019.

Posters Presented

1. Zhang, Xue[†], **David DeFranza**, & Marius Claudy. The behavioral and psychological impacts of virtual influencers: A systematic literature review and integrative framework. *Society for Consumer Psychology*. San Diego, California. March 26-29, 2026.
2. Vijayakumar, Suhas*, W. Yuna Yang, & **David DeFranza**. Lay beliefs about AI and its decision-making. *NSF AI-SDM Workshop on Human-AI Complementarity for Decision Making*. Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania. September 25-26, 2025.

3. **DeFranza, David***, Mike Lindow, Kevin Harrison, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. Religion and reactance to COVID-19 mitigation guidelines. *3i COVID-19 Symposium*. Salt Lake City, Utah. June 4, 2021.
4. **DeFranza, David***, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. Assessing attitudes toward brands across languages. *INFORMS Business Analytics Conference*. Virtual. April 12-14, 2021.
5. **DeFranza, David***, Arul Mishra, & Himanshu Mishra. How language influences attitudes toward brands. *Fourth Workshop on NLP and CSS at the 2020 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*. Virtual. November 20, 2020.
6. **DeFranza, David***, & Promothesh Chatterjee. The moderating effect of temporal borders on consumers' construal of market events: Evidence from Twitter. *Society for Consumer Psychology*. Huntington Beach, California. March 5-7, 2020.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Executive Education

Global Business in a Digital Environment, University College Dublin 2023, 2025

Graduate

Advanced Analytics and Big Data (MSc), University College Dublin	Summer 2023-2026
Digital Marketing and Social Media Management (MSc), University College Dublin (Singapore)	Feb 2026
Big Data Analytics (MSc/MIM), University College Dublin	Fall 2023-2025
Consumer Insights and Analytics (MSc), University College Dublin	Fall 2022-2025

Undergraduate

Digital Marketing Practice, University College Dublin (Singapore)	Feb 2024; Aug 2023, 2024
Consumer Insights and Analytics, University of Utah	Fall 2020

Mentorship

Xue Zhang (Ph.D. Co-advisor, University College Dublin) 2024-present

Teaching Innovations & Presentations

1. Claudy, Marius & David DeFranza. Teaching data analytics with Google Colab and Generative AI [Webinar]. *UCD College of Business Teaching Insights Series*, University College Dublin. February 16, 2026.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2026	Programming Committee Member, IEEE International Conference on Big Data
2025	External Examiner, Ph.D. viva, School of Psychology & School of Computing Science, University of Glasgow

2023 Scientific Committee Member, 16th Irish Economics and Psychology Conference
2020-2022 Instuctor, The Carpentries coding and data science workshops for researchers

Journal Reviewing

Applied Psychology, British Journal of Psychology, British Journal of Social Psychology, Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, Journal of Consumer Research, Journal of Gerontology: Social Sciences, Social Media + Society

Conference Reviewing

AMA Marketing and Public Policy Conference, AMA Summer Academic Conference, AMA Winter Academic Conference, European Marketing Academy Conference, IEEE International Conference on Big Data, Society for Consumer Psychology Annual Conference, Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Conference

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

2025-present Member, College of Business Teaching & Learning Committee, University College Dublin
2022 Reviewer, Doctoral Faculty Teaching Excellence Award, University of Utah
2021 Member, School of Business Academic Appeals Committee, University of Utah
2018-2020 Coordinator, Marketing Department Research Participant Pool, University of Utah

MEDIA ENGAGEMENT

2025 *Connected Magazine*. “Life changing: How TikTok Shop’s user-generated content is changing the way we buy online”
2024 *The National News*. “Are AI influencers the latest feature of modern life to make us unhappy?”

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2015-2017 Director, Optimization Strategy, Brooks Bell. Raleigh, NC
2013-2015 Senior Content Strategist, Brooks Bell. Raleigh, NC
2013 Marketing Communications Specialist, JMP Division, SAS Institute. Cary, NC
2008-2012 Assistant Editor, Web Producer, Discovery Communications. Silver Spring, MD
2007-2008 Content Producer, Mahalo.com. Santa Monica, CA
2005-2006 English Instructor, NOVA Eikaiwa Language School. Osaka, Japan

ADVANCED TRAINING & CERTIFICATIONS

2026 Equity, Diversity, & Inclusion Ambassador Certification, University College Dublin
2022 Universal Design for Learning, National Forum for the Enhancement of Teaching and Learning, Ireland
2018 SIOP/CARMA Reviewer Development Workshop, University of Nebraska (Online)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- 2025- European Marketing Academy (EMAC)
- 2021- Institute for Operations Research and the Management Sciences (INFORMS)
- 2021- American Marketing Association (AMA)
- 2019- Society for Consumer Psychology (SCP)

RELATED SKILLS

Tools: Python, R, Unix (Linux), L^AT_EX